ENG-0020

Postmortem Report: Inventory-Gateway System

Impact

The inventory-gateway system, part of Project Umbra, experienced two recent incidents of capacity exhaustion, both classified as Severity 3 (Sev3). These incidents, INC-011 and INC-038, resulted in service disruptions lasting approximately 32.5 hours each. The system's medium criticality underscores the importance of maintaining operational stability to support ongoing enterprise functions.

Timeline

- **INC-011** was reported by E-090, with the root cause identified as capacity exhaustion. The incident was resolved after 32.5 hours.
- **INC-038** was subsequently reported by E-092, also attributed to capacity exhaustion, and similarly resolved within 32.5 hours.

The incidents occurred within a short timeframe, highlighting recurring capacity issues that impacted system availability.

Root Cause

Both incidents were caused by capacity exhaustion within the inventory-gateway system. This root cause suggests that the current infrastructure and resource allocation were insufficient to handle peak loads, leading to system strain and outages.

Action Items

- Conduct a comprehensive review of the system's capacity planning and resource allocation strategies.
- Implement monitoring solutions to detect early signs of capacity exhaustion.
- Schedule a capacity upgrade for the inventory-gateway system to prevent future occurrences.
- Document findings and update incident response procedures accordingly.

Additional Context

The inventory-gateway system is owned by Project Umbra, which was completed with a start date of February 3, 2025. The system is managed by the on-call employee, Evelyn Galvan, a Paralegal based in Brisbane, and overseen by project lead Joyce Solis, a QA Engineer located in Perth. The system utilizes a Python/Django/MySQL tech stack and has a medium criticality rating.

This postmortem aims to inform ongoing efforts to enhance system resilience and ensure uninterrupted service delivery.